

Tattoo Artist Review - Content & SEO Strategy

This is the playbook. It maps the keyword set (keywords/keywords.csv, tracked in keywords/KEYWORD-TRACKER.md) onto a concrete page and blog strategy, and ties both to the real-world goal: **within 6 months, artists are messaging _you_ for a spot on the podcast.** We get there by owning the search results that artists' future clients are already typing in - so being featured here visibly sends an artist real bookings. That's the flywheel. Reviews -> traffic -> bookings -> artists want in -> better reviews -> more traffic.

1. The numbers we're playing for

The seed set is **2,130 unique keywords / ~13.0M monthly U.S. searches**. They cluster cleanly by intent:

Cluster	Keywords	Monthly volume	Where it lives on the site
Local / "near me"	66	2.12M	/map/, /cities/<state>/, /cities/<state>/<city>/, artist reviews
Motifs / subjects / ideas	1,628	4.02M	Blog galleries (one per motif)
Audience (for men/women/couples)	65	1.51M	Blog galleries
Body placement	95	1.34M	Blog galleries
Aftercare / pain / healing	86	707K	Blog guides
Styles	26	463K	/style/<slug>/ hubs
Lettering / fonts	29	331K	Blog + fonts hub
Removal / cover-up	18	180K	Blog guides
Meaning / symbolism	36	186K	Blog
Pricing	12	44K	Blog guide
Head terms	9	1.26M	Homepage + core (won on total authority)
Icebox - supplies/DIY	51	261K	_Parked - see ?6_
Toss - off-geo / temporary	8	607K	_Removed - see ?2_

The headline: the money is local. "tattoo shops near me" alone is 1.22M/mo, and the whole local cluster is 2.1M of high-intent, ready-to-book traffic. That cluster is exactly what the new site architecture is built to capture. The 4M-volume motif/idea long tail is the blog engine that builds the domain authority needed to _rank_ for that local intent.

2. Branded keywords - handled

You asked to strip branded keywords. After auditing all 2,130: **there are no competitor-brand or your-own-brand terms in this set to remove.** It's a clean generic seed list. The only thing masquerading

as "branded" is dataset noise:

- **Off-geo (Ireland):** `tattoo ireland`, `tattoo ie`, etc. - irrelevant to a U.S. 50-state brand. **Tossed.**

- **Temporary/novelty:** `henna tattoo`, airbrush, press-on. Off-brand for a permanent-ink review site. **Tossed.**

- **Product brands** (Aquaphor, Saniderm, Hustle Butter) are aftercare `_products_`, not competitors - they stay, folded into aftercare blog guides where they're genuinely useful.

All tossed terms are isolated in the **TOSS** cluster of the tracker so they never get a page. If you later have specific competitor brands you want to defend against or avoid, send them and I'll add a kill-list.

3. The architecture = the semantic takeover (already built)

The point of a "semantic takeover" is to have a dedicated, crawlable page for **every angle** a person can approach the niche from - geo and style - and to interlink them so authority flows. That structure now exists in the repo:

<code>/map/</code>	Interactive U.S. map - the hub of hubs
<code>/cities/</code>	All 50 states index
<code>/cities/<state>/</code>	State hub (x51, incl. DC - even empty ones)
<code>/cities/<state>/<city>/</code>	City hub (one per city we cover)
<code>/reviews/<state>/<city>/<artist>/</code>	The artist review (the asset that converts)
<code>/style/</code>	Style index
<code>/style/<slug>/</code>	Style hub (x18 canonical + any custom tag)

Every artist is now tagged two ways - by city and by style - and every tag is a clickable, indexable page. Click "psychedelic," "patriotic," or "Seattle" and you land on a page that lists the artists for it. That's the facet system you asked for, and it's what lets one artist rank for `psychedelic tattoo artist seattle` without you hand-building that page.

Why generate all 51 state hubs before they have artists: each empty hub is a live landing page targeting "best tattoo artists in `<state>`" `_and_` a standing "this crown is open" recruitment pitch. The map shows dark states as open territory. That's free inventory and a built-in reason for artists to reach out.

The interactive map

`/map/` renders all 50 states (+DC) as pressable buttons. Press a state -> it swaps to that state's cities -> press a city -> artists with their style tags. Gold-lit states already have artists; dark ones are open. It works without JavaScript too (each state button falls back to its hub page), so it's fully crawlable.

4. Page strategy (the hubs)

These are evergreen, templated, and grow automatically as you publish reviews. Each hub ships with substantial evergreen copy so it's **never a thin, empty listing** (Google penalizes thin programmatic pages - this is the #1 risk with a build like this, and the templates are written to avoid it).

Page	Targets	Primary keywords	Job
Homepage	brand + head	<code>tattoo artist</code> , <code>tattoo</code>	Authority + freshest reviews
<code>/map/</code>	local browse	<code>tattoo artist near me</code> family	The flagship discovery experience
<code>/cities/<state>/</code>	state geo	<code>best tattoo artists in <state></code>	Net for state-level + "open crown" CTA

/cities/<state>/<city> geo	tattoo shops in <city>, best tattoo artist <city>	The local money page
/style/<slug>/	<style> tattoo artist, <style> tattoo	Cross style x geo
/reviews/.../<artist> the artist	<artist name>, <style> tattoo <city>	The conversion asset

The review is the product. Everything else exists to funnel a ready-to-book searcher into a single artist's review, which links straight to their Instagram, shop, and booking. That measurable booking lift is your pitch to the next artist.

Editorial standard for reviews: minimum **1,000 words**, healed-work focus, 1-4 canonical style tags, real booking links. Use `templates/review.md`. Prefer canonical style names (see `src/_data/styleCatalog.js`) so artists pool onto the big style hubs instead of fragmenting into one-off tags.

5. Blog strategy - the authority + long-tail engine

The blog does two jobs: (1) vacuum up the 4M-volume motif/idea/placement long tail, and (2) build the topical authority the local hubs need to rank. **Every post is 1,000+ words, no exceptions**, and every post links `_down_` into relevant city, style, and artist pages - that internal linking is what turns blog traffic into ranking power for the money pages.

Five repeatable post formats (so production never stalls):

1. Motif gallery - X tattoo ideas (1,628 kws, 4.0M vol). The core engine.
 "40 Rose Tattoo Ideas (and the Artists Who Do Them Best)." Each gallery features real artists from the directory -> links to their reviews. One post per motif: rose, butterfly, cross, dragon, snake, phoenix, medusa, skull, lotus, etc. **This is where most blog volume lives - start here.**

1. Placement gallery - forearm/hand/neck/sleeve tattoos (1.34M). Same format, sliced by body part and often by audience (`forearm tattoos for men`).

1. Audience roundup - tattoos for men / women / couples / matching (1.51M).

2. Authority guides - aftercare, pain chart, healing stages, pricing, removal, cover-ups (1.2M combined). These earn trust and backlinks. Fold the product terms (Aquaphor/Saniderm) in here.

1. Meaning explainers - X tattoo meaning (186K). Short to write, strong internal-link bait into the matching motif gallery.

Podcast tie-in: every podcast interview becomes a blog post `_and_` feeds the artist's review. The episode is the relationship; the review + gallery placement is the deliverable that sends them bookings. That's the hook that gets the next ten artists to call you.

Cadence: the homepage feed alternates review - blog - review - blog, so keep roughly 1:1. Target ~3 reviews + 3 blog posts/week to start; front-load motif galleries (fast to produce, highest volume) while you build the review base.

6. What we are deliberately NOT chasing (yet)

- **Supplies / DIY / machines** (`tattoo gun`, `tattoo machine`, `needles`, `stencils` - 261K). Wrong audience: these are aspiring/working tattooers and hobbyists, not people booking the artists you feature, and not your podcast guests' clients. Parked in the **Icebox**. Only revisit if you add an affiliate gear-review vertical.
- **Off-geo & temporary** - tossed (see ?2).

Saying no here is the strategy. Chasing 261K of low-fit volume would dilute the site's topical focus and slow the local rankings that actually matter.

7. Internal linking model (how authority flows)

```
Homepage --> /map/ --> state hub --> city hub --> ARTIST REVIEW
      --> /style/ --> style hub -----> ARTIST REVIEW
      --> /blog/ --> motif gallery -----> ARTIST REVIEW
                    meaning post --> motif gallery
artist review --> its city hub, its state hub, each of its style hubs
```

Every page points toward an artist review; every review points back up to its city/state/style hubs. No orphan pages. The sitemap (</sitemap.xml>) auto-includes everything.

8. 6-month roadmap (mapped to the podcast goal)

- **Month 1 - Foundation.** Architecture is live (done). Publish the first 15-20

real reviews across 3-4 anchor cities. Ship 8-10 motif galleries (rose, butterfly, dragon, snake, cross, skull + the small/simple "ideas" terms).

- **Month 2 - Density.** Reach ~40 reviews. Light up 8-10 states on the map.

Publish the 5 authority guides (aftercare, pain, cost, removal, healing).

- **Month 3 - Style takeover.** Ensure every canonical style hub has ≥ 3 featured

artists. Add placement + audience galleries. First local rankings should appear.

- **Month 4 - Proof.** Start showing artists their referral traffic/booking lift.

This is when inbound interest begins.

- **Month 5 - Flywheel.** Podcast episodes feeding reviews weekly; artists begin

reaching out for spots.

- **Month 6 - Inbound.** Goal state: a waitlist for the podcast and the directory

ranking for [best tattoo artist in <city>](#) in your anchor markets.

9. Working the tracker

[keywords/KEYWORD-TRACKER.md](#) lists all 2,130 keywords grouped by the clusters above, each with a checkbox, monthly volume, and competition.

- **Check a box when the page/post that targets it goes live.**
- Work top-down by cluster: Local first (highest intent), then knock out motif

galleries (highest volume), then guides.

- One published page typically checks off several keywords (a single rose gallery covers [rose tattoo](#), [rose tattoo ideas](#), [rose tattoos for men](#), etc.).

- Re-run the generator if you refresh the CSV; clustering is deterministic.

Measure in Google Search Console by cluster: local impressions/clicks are the leading indicator that the flywheel is turning.